

Activity 13: Global Tech Ambassador & Open-Source Pathway Selection

Portfolio Building B25CS0311 | 3rd Semester B.Tech CSE | Track: Open-Source & Community Leadership

Part A: Program Analysis & Target Selection

I selected **GitHub Campus Experts** and the **MLH Fellowship**. Both suit an Open-Source / Community Leadership track, and both are reachable from 3rd semester: GitHub Campus Experts needs more than 12 months before graduation, and the MLH Fellowship rewards early hands-on contribution.

Criteria	GitHub Campus Experts	MLH Fellowship
Focus	Campus community building, public speaking, leadership	12-week production open-source fellowship with real engineer mentors
Eligibility	Active GitHub user for more than 6 months; more than 1 year left until graduation	18+ years; prior coding or hackathon experience; 20-30 hrs/week commitment
Cycle & deadline	Biannual; next cycle around February 2027	Rolling batches; Fall deadline Aug 31, Spring deadline in January
Perks	Public speaking and leadership training, event funding	Open-source stipend, mentorship, production-grade experience
Why it fits me	Lets me run workshops and grow a campus open-source culture	Turns beginner contributions into professional-level engineering skill

Part B: Readiness Assessment & Gap Analysis

Self-assessment of my current portfolio against each program's requirements:

Area	Current status	Gap to close
GitHub history	Account with coursework repos; little consistent activity	Need visible activity over 6+ months and a steady commit streak
Open-source contributions	No merged pull requests to external projects yet	Need at least 3 merged PRs (docs, bug fixes, 'good first issue')
Technical writing	No public articles or READMEs beyond course submissions	Need 2 short blog posts / a polished README on my best project
Community involvement	Informal peer help only	Need one organised event, e.g. a Git/GitHub workshop

4-week preparation timeline

- **Week 1 - Foundation:** Clean up my GitHub profile (bio, pinned repos, README profile), add READMEs to my top 3 repos, and commit code daily. Shortlist 10 beginner-friendly issues across active projects.
- **Week 2 - Contribute:** Open and submit 2 pull requests (documentation fixes and one small bug fix). Respond promptly to maintainer feedback.
- **Week 3 - Write & Build:** Publish one technical blog post about my contribution experience. Ship a small project, or enter a hackathon, to show I can build end to end.
- **Week 4 - Community & Apply:** Host a short Git/GitHub session for juniors, collect attendance proof, finalise the 250-word essay, and submit applications before the deadlines.

Part C: Drafted Application Response (250-word community motivation essay)

I am a third-semester Computer Science student, and the most important thing I have learned so far is that I grow fastest when I build alongside other people. Coursework taught me syntax; reading other people's pull requests and explaining my own taught me engineering. That is why I want to join a global tech community, and why the GitHub Campus Experts program fits where I am headed.

On my campus, many students own laptops but never open a repository, because they assume open source is only for experts. I want to change that. I plan to run monthly Git and GitHub workshops where first-year students make a real contribution within a single session. Fixing a documentation typo or triaging an issue is still a merged pull request, and it removes the fear of the first step. I will also publish short written guides so the knowledge outlasts any single event.

I am equally drawn to the MLH Fellowship, because it would push me beyond tutorial projects into production code reviewed by working engineers. I am preparing by contributing to beginner-friendly issues, practising good code-review etiquette, and shipping small projects through hackathons. Whatever I learn there, I will bring back to my campus community.

My goal is simple: to grow as an engineer and make sure the next student finds the door already open. I bring consistency, curiosity, and a willingness to teach, and I would be proud to represent my campus in this global community.